

11.5 Making Shared Folders

Now let's see how to share folders on the network. This will not only allow easy transfer of data, but also save disk space by not forcing you to have replicas of files across systems. Sharing of folders is far easier than sharing a printer. To share a folder, select the folder you want to share, right-click on it and select 'Sharing and Security'. You'll now see a 'Sharing' tab in the folder properties. Under 'Network sharing and security', select 'Share this folder on the network'. Now, in the text box named 'Share name', type the name you want other people to see.

There are two ways you can allow the people to access your shared folder. If you want to allow other computers on the network to access the shared folder using Windows Explorer then just type in the name others want to see. But if you want only people who know the path of the folder to access the folder, add the "\$" symbol at the end of the folder name you just gave. This adds more security to the shared folders. Windows XP does not allow more than 10 persons to simultaneously access the same folder. Dollar (\$) shares are recommended because they prevent the spread of viruses on a network, and are especially important for folders that are shared with write-access.

To access a dollar-share folder called "shared\$" on a computer called "Digit", all you have to do is go to Start > Run, type in \\digit\shared\$, and press [Enter]. You can do this for regular shared folders as well.

11.6 Assigning A Drive Letter To A Shared Folder

Now, once you have shared folders, you can assign drives on the second computer to the shared folders on the first. What this does is prevent you from searching for, or typing in something like \\digit\sharedfolder\$ every time you want to access a shared fold-